PLAYMAKER

OPEN YOUR EYES

"Every possession asks one question: what is the best shot you can create before the clock runs out? Read the floor. Find the mismatch. Make the extra pass."

2 PLAYERS · 12+ AGE · 30–60 MINUTES

DESIGN: SHAUN BARTLETT

Aim of the game

Two players, two possessions. Each player attacks once and defends once.

You have 12 seconds to build the best shot you can. Shots are never rolled: a shot scores what it was worth. The higher score wins.

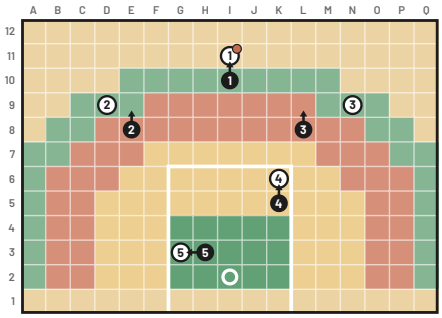
So reading the floor beats luck. Find the open player, the mismatch, the right moment to shoot.

In the box

Component	What it's for
Court board	Where you play. It also shows shot zones, the shot clock and key rules.
2 trackers	One for offence, one for defence. **Every action's rules are printed here.**
75 player cards	Offence ratings on the front, defence on the back.
10 player pieces	5 white O (screen T on the back), 5 black X with an arrow.
12 action tokens	6 white, 6 black. One token is one action.
4 lock tokens	Mark a player who can't move this phase.
Ball and d20	The ball sits on the ball carrier.
Shot clock marker	Counts down the 12 seconds.
Score book	For scores, fouls and turnovers.
First-game guides and playbook	Optional. Worked examples and plays to try.

Setup

1. Each player takes 5 player cards, one per position. For your first game, use a prescribed team.
2. Roll the d20. The higher roll attacks first and sits on the **left**, with the offence tracker.
3. Put the shot clock marker on **12**.
4. The offence places its 5 O pieces anywhere. The ball goes on a player standing on plain wood beyond the three-point tiles.
5. The defence places its 5 X pieces on empty squares. Point each arrow any way you like.
6. Each player puts their 6 action tokens in their tracker's action pool.



A typical start. Squares are named by column and row, like I11.

The shot

Every shot is worth:

Shot value

points × (rating – contest)

Points: 2 or 3, from the tile the shooter stands on.
Rating: the shooter's card rating for that shot.
Contest: the nearest defender's rating against it.

Example: a shooter rated 13 from mid-range, contested by a 4: 2 × (13 – 4) = **18**.

Reading the court

The coloured tiles show the points for a shot from that square.

- 2 — Layup, dunk, post move
- 3 — Three-pointer
- 2 — Mid-range, floater
- 2 — Long two
- – — Plain wood: no shot

Rolling

Roll the d20. You **succeed** on **equal to or under** your rating minus theirs. Pass 15 v Intercept 7: 8 or less.

Choose with the marks, then do the sum

Your mark v theirs:

▲ v ▼	Always great.
Plain v plain	Okay if nothing better.
▼ v ▲	Only with a lucky roll.

Playing a possession

The possession is played in **phases** of 2 seconds. Repeat these steps until someone shoots or the clock runs out.

1. Take turns

The offence goes first. Then the teams take turns. On your turn, take **1 or 2 actions**.

To take an action, move an action token from your pool into the player's slot on your tracker. Your tracker explains each action.

Actions below the black bar **end your turn**. Play them last.

2. End the phase

The phase ends when:

- the offence plays its last token. The defence gets one more turn first.
- the defence plays its last token. It ends at once.
- a shot is taken.

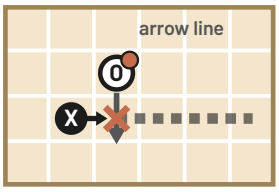
3. Reset

Put all action tokens back in the pools. Remove lock tokens. Move the shot clock down 2. Players stay where they are.

If the clock reaches **0** before a shot: **turnover, –5**, and the ball carrier takes a forced shot from where the pieces stand, contested as normal. Plain wood, or a value below 0, scores 0.

Defender arrows

Each X piece points an arrow. **Next to** always includes diagonals.



The ball carrier can't drive across this arrow line.

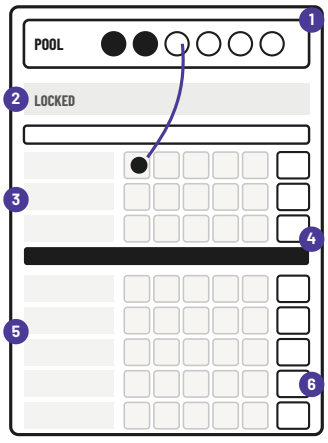
- **Pointing at the ball carrier**: the defender can Steal and contest cleanly.
- **Pointing elsewhere, next to the ball carrier**: the ball carrier can't cross the arrow's line without winning a Dribble.
- **Any arrow**: threatens passes that cross it.

Shooting

Declare a Shot. The defence takes one last turn to react. Then the nearest defender contests.

A defender further from the rim than the shooter contests at **–3**. The court's Shot Value box has the details.

Your tracker



Your tracker explains every action. You won't need to look anything up mid-game.

1. **Action pool**: your 6 action tokens.
2. **Locked**: lock tokens go here.
3. **Movement**: these don't end your turn.
4. **Limit**: how often each action can be used per phase.
5. **Below the black bar**: these end your turn.
6. Each row explains **when**, the **roll** and the **result**.

Scoring

Tick fouls and turnovers in the score book as they happen.

What happened	Score
Intercept or steal	–5, play on
First foul on a steal	+5, play on
Second foul on a steal	Free throws, possession ends
Foul on a shot	Free throws, possession ends
Shot clock hits 0	Forced shot as they stand, –5

Free throws score 2 × the shooter's FT rating, or 3 × on a three-point shot.

Winning

After the first possession, swap seats and trackers, flip every player card, and set up again.

After both possessions, the **higher score wins**. Tied? Each player rolls for their final shot: d20 ≤ rating – contest. A make beats a miss.

The score book also rates each possession, from Poor to Excellent, so you can track how well you played even when you lose.

Ready?

You know enough to play. Keep your tracker in front of you: it explains every action as you need it.